

Tabloid TECH

People And Events That Grabbed Headlines—For Better Or For Worse

Yank That Cell Away

Parents looking for a punishment for their wayward teens, which does not involve beating or locking them in the wardrobe, should consider confiscating their mobile phones: a study by a South Korean advertising firm shows that a mobile is a Korean teenager's most prized possession, and that taking them away from them is a bit like social castration.

The Cheil Communications survey found that of 13- to 15-year-olds, 77.5 per cent said a mobile phone was a 'must-have' item, while for those aged 16 to 18, the figure was 76.7 per cent, the survey showed.

The survey indicated that teens felt helpless without their mobile, thus taking it away from them would be a really good punishment.



Was Carly all that bad?

They Survived Carly Fiorina!

A Web site is offering a selection of products celebrating the "Carly Fiorina Years". The items available at www.cafepress.com/carly_survivor include mugs, shirts and other paraphernalia, and carry the logo "I survived the Carly Fiorina Years".

The site says the items commemorate "your survival, or not, through

Carly's tenure as CEO" and let you tell the world all about it. Was she all that bad?!

Apparently. Some readers might recall that Fiorina was a controversial figure at HP, partly because of the abrasive manner in which the takeover of Compaq was fought in 2001 and 2002. As a matter of fact, HP shares rose 7.5 per cent after the news of Fiorina's stepping down!

DVD For The Mourners!

An Australian undertaker is offering a hearse with its own mini-bar, DVD player and coffee maker. It is fitted with chrome handrails, tinted windows, pop-out cup holders and atmospheric lighting.

The mint green hearse can hold up to 12 mourners and a coffin, reports *The Sydney Morning Herald*.

Martin Tobin, of Tobin Brothers Funeral in Melbourne, said: "We already know that this will not be for everyone, and we are not saying that this is the only way to have a funeral.

"But for those who want to be together and travel with the deceased, particularly those with large families, it is a good option for them."

The family funeral bus costs £400 (Rs 32,600).

What's with all these funeral gadgets coming out these days? Earlier, in this space, we spoke about a German inventor's tasteless invention that lets you talk to the dead—a gadget you bury in the ground along with the body so you can call up the body and speak to it.

And now this! Imagine people dressed all in black, sipping Foster's and watching their favourite DVDs in between sniffs. Whatever happened to good old-fashioned mourning?

Toying With Cybersex

Would you have cybersex with someone you met through an online dating site? Would you go on a date with someone you met through a cybersex chat room? HighJoy is betting you will.

HighJoy is a fusion of a dating database, a proprietary chat client, and 'teledildonics'—the integration of telepresence with sex.

Amir Vatan, CEO, describes the company as something between AdultFriendFinder and Match.com. He sees HighJoy as the logical next step for those who enjoy making connections online. Now that we're used to the idea of meeting people

through personal profiles and Internet communities, "people are looking for an increased level of interaction," he says.

Members fill out profiles, in varying degrees of detail. You can search the database by characteristic or member name, contact people through anonymous e-mail and have private chats. A favourites list lets you keep track of people you're most intrigued by.

And, of course, you can invite someone to control your vibrator while you control theirs.

For the monogamous, HighJoy offers a 'one-on-one' membership that lets you sign on to chat privately with each other and control each other's



HighJoy—very adult, very "with it"

sex toys, without access to the community rooms and profiles. You can't contact people through their profiles, and they can't see yours.

Seriously, this idea—"something between AdultFriendFinder and Match.com"—strikes us as a good idea, and as a sign of the times.

3-Easy-Steps to Freebies!

- 1 Log on to www.thinkdigit.com/digitpatron to register.
- 2 Enter this 16-digit code and score points (you will find your code at this place every issue)
- 3 Your points get added every month and can be redeemed for exciting gifts!

